

Patient 101:
Lesson 5:

The Care Follow-Through

The Visit Isn't Over When You Walk Out.

Empowering Health Together

No News is NOT
Good News!

Results get lost, portals glitch,
and "we'll call you" too often
turns into silence.
Calling to check on your
results is not rude or annoying—
it is simply the next step in
your care.
Speak up, you are not a bother!

Part 1: The Three Appointment "Locks"

Fill this out before you leave today!



Lock 1: The Plan



Know what happens next.

My next clinical step is:

By when should this happen?



Leave with a plan,
not just paperwork!



Lock 2: Expected Results



Know what to expect.

What test/lab was ordered?

Expected date of results:

Direct callback phone number:

Proactive Action Line:



If I don't hear anything by

Date: _____,

I will call them directly.



Lock 3: Proactive Referral Lock



Make sure your referral happens.

Name of referred clinic/specialist:

Specialist phone number:

The 1-Week Proactive Rule:



If nobody calls you within
1 week to schedule,
call this number directly
to check on your appointment.



Be proactive — you deserve care!



Part 2: Phone-Side "No-Freeze" Scripts

It's okay to make the call!
Use these scripts or make them your own.



Script 1: Chasing Lab/Test Results

"Hi, my name is [Name], and I'm calling to follow up on the lab work I had done on [Date]. I haven't seen the results in my portal yet, and I wanted to confirm if they have been reviewed by my provider."



Script 2: Chasing a Referral

"Hi, I'm calling to follow up on a referral placed by [Doctor's Name] to [Specialist Name] on [Date]. Could you let me know if the referral has been processed, or if there is a direct number I should call to schedule?"



Script 3: The Missing Callback

"Hi, I'm calling because I left a message regarding [Topic] on [Date] and haven't heard back yet. I want to make sure my message reached the clinical team."



Advocate.
Follow up.
Keep moving forward.
You've got this!

The appointment is the beginning,
not the end.

Take charge of your story.



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